

Simple Invoice Manager (SIM) — RAG-Optimized Knowledge Base

This knowledge base is structured for retrieval-augmented generation (RAG). Each section begins with a [Topic] label for accurate chunk retrieval. Tables are converted to bullet points. FAQs are included at the end of each section.

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[Topic: Purchase Orders]

7. Purchase Orders

Definition

A Purchase Order (PO) is a document sent by the business to a supplier to formally request goods before they are received. It records what is being ordered, in what quantity, and at what agreed price. It serves as a binding commitment between the buyer and supplier before any physical exchange takes place.

When & Who

- Used by retailers, wholesalers, manufacturers, and any business that procures stock from suppliers in advance.
- Raised when the business wants to formalize an order before goods are dispatched.
- Common in formal B2B procurement where documentation is required at every step.

Flow / Navigation:

- **Flow for creating the Purchase Order:** Dashboard → Side Menu (☰) → Purchase Order section → Add Purchase Order → Save → Status: Pending (order accepted, not yet delivered/invoiced).
- **Flow for creating the Purchase Order to Purchase Record:** When ready to deliver: tap the Purchase order → Make Purchase Record → Save. (Once payment is paid, Purchase order status updates to Completed.)

Key Fields

- **Discount** — Any price reduction agreed upon with the supplier for this order.

Purchase Order Statuses

- **Pending** — Order created and sent but goods not yet received.
- **Completed** — Goods received and a purchase record created against this PO.
- **Manually Completed** — PO force-closed manually even if not fully fulfilled.
- **Cancelled** — Purchase order completely cancelled and will not be processed.

Key Concepts

Purchase Order vs. Purchase Record

- A PO is a request — created before goods arrive. Does not affect inventory or accounts.
- A Purchase Record is the accounting entry made after goods are physically received. Affects inventory and accounts.
- Many small businesses skip POs and go directly to purchase records. Formal procurement workflows use both.

Why use a Purchase Order

- The supplier has a documented commitment to fulfill.
- The buyer has a record of the agreed price, quantity, and items — which can be verified when goods arrive.
- Discrepancies between the PO and what is received are caught at the point of entry.

Reference Number on Purchase Record

- When a purchase record is created from a purchase order, it is automatically assigned the corresponding PO reference number.
- Two purchase orders from the same supplier can be combined into a single purchase record.

Alternate Terms

- Purchase Order is also called: PO, Procurement Order, Supply Request, Indent
- Supplier is also called: Vendor, Seller, Distributor, Creditor
- Buy Rate is also called: Agreed Rate, Order Price, Purchase Price

Video Tutorial

Purchase Order & Record: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IKUJ9sprbJU> (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IKUJ9sprbJU>),

FAQs

Q: What is a purchase order in SIM? A: A purchase order is a document sent to a supplier to formally request goods before they arrive. It records the order details but does not affect inventory or accounts until goods are received.

Q: What is the difference between a purchase order and a purchase record? A: A purchase order is sent before goods arrive — it is a formal request. A purchase record is created after goods are received — it is the accounting entry that updates inventory and tracks supplier payment.

Q: How to convert a purchase order to a purchase record? A: Tap on the purchase order → tap Make Purchase Record → save. Once payment is made, the PO status updates to Completed.

Q: What does Manually Completed mean on a purchase order? A: Manually Completed means the purchase order was force-closed by the user even if it was not fully received or fulfilled.

Q: Can two purchase orders be merged into one purchase record? A: Yes. Two purchase orders from the same supplier can be combined to create a single purchase record.

[Topic: Purchase Records]

8. Purchase Records

Definition

A Purchase Record is the accounting entry created when goods are actually received from a supplier. It formally records the inward movement of stock, updates inventory quantities, and tracks the payment owed to the supplier. It can be created by converting a completed Purchase Order or directly as a standalone entry.

When & Who

- Used by any business that buys physical goods from suppliers — shops, wholesalers, distributors.
- Created at the moment goods arrive, regardless of whether a PO was raised.

Flow / Navigation:

Dashboard → Side Menu (☰) → Purchase → Add New Purchase Record

Key Fields

- **Supplier** — The vendor from whom goods were received.
- **Purchase Date** — The date goods were received.
- **Items** — Products received including name, quantity, buy rate, and tax.
- **Buy Rate / Purchase Rate** — The price paid to the supplier per unit. Used for inventory cost and profit tracking.
- **Opening Stock** — The quantity on hand when the product was first added to the app. Enter this only once during product creation. Never enter it again in a purchase record for an existing product — it will double-count inventory.
- **Opening Stock Rate** — Cost price per unit at the time of first stock entry.
- **Minimum Alert Level** — The reorder threshold for this product.
- **Discount** — Price reduction received from the supplier on this purchase.
- **Payment Status** — Whether the supplier has been fully paid, partially paid, or not yet paid.

Purchase Record Statuses

- **Unpaid** — Supplier has not yet been paid.
- **Partially Paid** — Some payment made; a balance remains.
- **Paid** — Supplier fully paid.

Actions Available After Creating a Purchase Record

- **Edit** — Modify purchase record details such as images, notes, items, or names.
- **Preview** — View the purchase record as image or PDF.
- **Send** — Send using a template to any recipient.
- **Share** — Share directly as image or PDF.
- **Print** — Print using Normal or Thermal Printer.
- **Mark as Paid** — Record payment (Cash or Bank).
- **Create Duplicate** — Create an exact copy without client details.
- **Make Purchase Return** — Initiate a purchase return from this record.
- **Delete** — Permanently remove the purchase record.

Important Rule: Opening Stock

If a product's opening stock was already entered during product creation, do not enter it again in a purchase record. The app will count it twice, resulting in an inflated inventory figure.

Alternate Terms

- Purchase Record is also called: Purchase Entry, Purchase Invoice, Goods Receipt, GRN, Inward Entry
- Supplier is also called: Vendor, Seller, Distributor, Creditor
- Buy Rate is also called: Cost Price, Purchase Price, Landed Cost
- Unpaid is also called: Outstanding, Due, Payable

Video Tutorials

- How to Create a Purchase Record: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=282YfSveQs> (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=282YfSveQs>).
- Purchase Order & Record: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IKUJ9sprbJU> (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IKUJ9sprbJU>).

FAQs

Q: What is a purchase record in SIM? A: A purchase record is the accounting entry created when goods are received from a supplier. It updates inventory stock and tracks payment owed to the supplier.

Q: How to create a purchase record in SIM? A: From the dashboard, Side Menu (☰) → Purchase section → Add New Purchase Record → select supplier → add items → apply discount and tax if applicable → add payment if made → Preview → Save.

Q: Why should I not enter opening stock again in a purchase record? A: If opening stock was already entered when creating the product, entering it again in a purchase record will count the same stock twice, inflating your inventory figures. Opening stock is a one-time entry made only at product setup.

Q: How to mark a purchase as paid in SIM? A: Open the purchase record from the purchase list → tap Mark as Paid → select payment method (Cash or Bank) → save.

Q: What reports are available for purchases? A: You can check Purchase/Payment Report, Detailed Purchase Report, and Purchase Order Report from the Reports section.

[Topic: Inventory Management]

9. Inventory Management

Definition

Inventory management in SIM tracks the quantity of physical goods a business holds at any point in time. Stock levels update automatically — increasing when purchases are recorded and decreasing when sales (invoices) are made. The feature also supports manual adjustments and low-stock alerts.

When & Who

- Relevant only for businesses dealing in physical goods: shops, wholesalers, distributors, manufacturers.
- Not applicable to pure service businesses.
- Should be enabled as part of initial app setup.

Flow / Navigation:

Settings → Enable / Disable Features → Inventory → Enable

What Affects Inventory

Actions that INCREASE stock:

- Purchase Record
- Manual Stock-In adjustment

Actions that DECREASE stock:

- Invoice (Sale)
- Manual Stock-Out adjustment

Actions that DO NOT affect inventory:

- Estimate / Quotation
- Sale Order
- Purchase Order
- Delivery Note

Key Fields

- **Enable Product Inventory** — Turn this on per product to track its stock. Should be off for services.
- **Opening Stock** — The quantity of the item available at the beginning when the product is first added to the app.
- **Opening Stock Rate** — The cost price per unit at the time of initial stock entry (buy rate).
- **Minimum Alert Level** — The stock threshold below which the app sends a low-stock alert.
- **Stock-In** — When stock quantity increases (e.g., from a purchase or manual addition).
- **Stock-Out** — When stock quantity decreases (e.g., from a sale or manual removal).
- **Inventory Valuation Method** — The accounting rule used to calculate the cost of items when they are sold.

Manual Inventory Adjustment

Allows stock levels to be updated without creating a sale or purchase transaction. Used for:

- Items consumed internally or personally
- Damaged or expired goods
- Free samples given out
- Inventory corrections after physical stock count
- Lost or stolen goods
- Opening stock adjustments

Navigation: Side Menu (☰) → Inventory → Add Inventory Manually → select Stock In or Stock Out → enter quantity and reason → Save.

Automatic Inventory Adjustment

When a purchase record is created, stock quantity is automatically updated for the respective products in inventory.

Inventory Valuation Methods

1. Actual Average Buy Rate (Weighted Average Cost) — Recommended

- Calculates the average cost of all units purchased over time.
- When an item is sold, its cost is recorded at this weighted average.
- Example: 10 units at ₹100 + 10 units at ₹120 → average = ₹110 per unit.
- Best for: Most businesses. Smooths out price fluctuations.

2. FIFO (First In, First Out)

- Assumes the oldest stock purchased is sold first.
- Example: Batch 1 (10 units at ₹100) → Batch 2 (10 units at ₹120). Sales come from Batch 1 first.
- Best for: Perishable goods (food, medicine, cosmetics).
- Financial effect: In rising-price environments, FIFO results in lower cost of goods sold and higher reported profit.

3. Fixed Buy Rate

- Uses a single manually defined cost price regardless of actual purchase price fluctuations.
- Example: Fixed rate ₹100. Even if you later buy at ₹130, cost is still recorded as ₹100.
- Best for: Businesses with stable, predictable purchase prices.

Key Concept: Negative Inventory

Negative inventory occurs when the system shows stock below zero. This typically happens when a sale (invoice) or stock-out is recorded before the corresponding stock-in (purchase) is entered.

Optional Sub-Feature: Physical Stock-Take (Reconciliation)

At the end of the day, differences may exist between the app's calculated inventory and the actual physical stock. The Physical Stock-Take feature allows correction of such differences by adding reconciliation edits to products along with their actual current stock.

Dependencies and Side Effects

- **Reorder Management** — Automatically generates purchase order suggestions when stock falls below the minimum alert level.
- **Batch Upload (Inventory Data)** — Large amounts of product and inventory data can be updated at once using a CSV or Excel file.
- **Cost of Goods Sold (COGS)** — COGS is directly tied to the selected inventory valuation method.

Alternate Terms

- Inventory is also called: Stock, Goods, Merchandise, Stockroom, Store
- Stock-In is also called: Goods Received, Inward, Purchase Entry, Positive Adjustment
- Stock-Out is also called: Goods Issued, Outward, Sales Deduction, Negative Adjustment

- Minimum Alert Level is also called: Reorder Point, Safety Stock Level, Low Stock Threshold
- FIFO is also called: First In First Out, Queue Method
- Weighted Average is also called: Moving Average, Average Cost Method, WAC
- Inventory Valuation is also called: Stock Valuation, Cost Method
- Physical Stock-Take is also called: Reconciliation

Sub-Settings

- **Enable Inventory Management Feature:** Master toggle that activates stock tracking across the app.
- **Enable Low Inventory Level Alert:** Sends an alert when a product's stock goes below its minimum alert level.
- **Enable Inventory Automatically for New Products:**
 - When enabled: inventory tracking is automatically applied to all new products
 - When disabled: inventory must be enabled manually for each product
- **Inventory Valuation Method:** Determines how the cost of sold stock is calculated
 - Options include:
 - Actual Average Buy Rate (recommended)
 - FIFO
 - Fixed Buy Rate (set in Settings)

After enabling inventory, the app prompts you to:

- Select existing products for inventory activation
- Enter opening stock quantity
- Enter opening stock rate
- Set minimum alert level

Video Tutorials

- How to Enable Inventory: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wU3bhD1PhSs> (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wU3bhD1PhSs>)
- Add or Remove Inventory Manually: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pFQdvYH_mok (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pFQdvYH_mok)

FAQs

Q: How to enable inventory management in SIM? A: Go to Settings → Enable / Disable Features → Inventory → enable the feature and sub-settings as required. Then select which products to track and enter opening stock, opening stock rate, and minimum alert level for each.

Q: How to check inventory status? A: Go to Side Menu (☰) → Inventory → Check Inventory Status. This shows the current stock quantity for all inventory-enabled products.

Q: What is the difference between Stock-In and Stock-Out? A: Stock-In means stock quantity increases (from a purchase or manual addition). Stock-Out means stock quantity decreases (from a sale or manual removal).

Q: Does creating a sale order reduce inventory? A: No. Sale orders, purchase orders, estimates, and delivery notes do not affect inventory. Only actual invoices (sales) and purchase records affect stock levels.

Q: What is FIFO inventory valuation? A: FIFO (First In, First Out) assumes the oldest stock is sold first. It is best for perishable goods like food, medicine, and cosmetics where older stock must be sold before expiry.

Q: What is the Weighted Average inventory valuation method? A: The Weighted Average method calculates the average cost of all units purchased over time. When any unit is sold, its cost is recorded at this average. It is the recommended method for most businesses.

Q: What is negative inventory? A: Negative inventory occurs when the app shows stock below zero. This typically happens when a sale is recorded before the corresponding purchase entry is made.

Q: How to do a manual inventory adjustment? A: Go to Side Menu (☰) → Inventory → Add Inventory Manually → select Stock In or Stock Out → enter quantity and reason → Save.

Q: What is Physical Stock-Take? A: Physical Stock-Take (Reconciliation) is a feature that corrects differences between the app's calculated stock and the actual physical stock in the warehouse by entering reconciliation edits.

Q: What is Low Inventory Alert? A: Low Inventory Alert is a feature that notifies you when a product's stock falls below a predefined minimum level. For example, if you have 100 apples and set the minimum alert level to 10, you will receive an alert/notification when the stock goes below 10.

Q: Where can I check Low Inventory Alerts? A: You can view all products with low stock by navigating to: Side Menu (☰) → Inventory → Low Inventory Level Alert

[Topic: Sale Returns Refunds Credit Notes]

10. Sale Returns, Refunds & Credit Notes

Definition

Sale Return A sale return is created when a customer returns goods they bought. The original invoice is never deleted — it records that the sale happened. A sale return is created instead, which connects to the original invoice, records what was returned, keeps the sale record accurate, and puts returned items back into inventory.

Credit Note A credit note records the money value of returned goods. It stores how much is owed back to the customer. The amount can either be refunded in cash or bank, or adjusted against a future invoice.

Credit Note must be enabled in Settings before use.

When & Who

- Any business that accepts returns: retailers, wholesalers, e-commerce sellers.

- Also used for goodwill credits, discount coupons, overcharges, or quality complaint adjustments without any physical goods return.

Navigation

- Sale Return: Invoice List → tap on an invoice → Make Sale Return
- Credit Note: Side Menu → Credit Note → Create

Key Fields

- **Return Quantity** — Number of units being returned. Cannot exceed the original invoice quantity.
- **Refund Amount** — The monetary value returned to the client in cash or via bank transfer.
- **Credit Note Amount** — The value of credit issued to the client for future use.
- **Credit Note Status** — Whether the credit has been applied against an invoice yet.
- **Sale Return Status** — Whether the monetary value of returned goods has been refunded.
- **Adjustment Amount** — The portion of a credit note being applied to a specific invoice.
- **Remaining Credit Balance** — The unused portion of a credit note still available for future transactions.

Statuses

Sale Return statuses:

- **Not Refunded** — Return recorded; money not yet returned to client.
- **Refunded** — Money has been returned to client.

Credit Note statuses:

- **Not Adjusted** — Credit exists but not yet applied to an invoice.
- **Adjusted** — Credit has been fully applied against invoice(s).

Credit Note Use Cases

A credit note can be issued when:

- A client returns goods (automatically linked to the sale return)
- A client was overcharged on a previous invoice
- A goodwill gesture or loyalty reward is offered
- A quality complaint is being settled
- A promotional discount is applied after a sale

Credit Note: Refund vs. Adjustment

- **Refund** — Money is physically returned to the client (cash, bank, UPI). Credit note marked as refunded.
- **Adjustment** — No money changes hands. Credit amount reduces the client's next invoice total. Credit note marked as adjusted.
- **Partial Adjustment** — Part of the credit is used on one invoice; the remaining balance carries forward.

- **Multi-Invoice Adjustment** — A single credit note can be split and applied across multiple unpaid or partially paid invoices.

Key Concept: Why Not Delete the Original Invoice

Deleting an invoice when goods are returned misrepresents financial history. The original sale happened and must stay in the books. A sale return is a contra entry — it offsets the original without erasing it. This is a principle of double-entry bookkeeping.

Key Concept: Which Invoices Appear in Multi-Invoice Adjustment

Only invoices where payment is not received or partially received are shown. Fully paid invoices do not appear because there is nothing to adjust against.

Key Concept: Credit Note Feature Toggle

When enabled in Settings, every sale return automatically generates a linked credit note. When disabled, sale returns are recorded without a credit note — only simple refunds are possible.

Interaction with Other Features

- **Invoice** — Sale return is always linked to the original invoice.
- **Credit Note** — A credit note is created for every sale return to record the refund or adjustment amount.
- **Inventory** — Stock is automatically updated when a sale return is created (items are added back).
- **Reports** — Sale returns are reflected in reports and affect business metrics.
- **Client Transaction History** — Shows the sale return and updates the client's balance (reduces amount they owe).
- **Payment Received** — When recording payments, the sale return amount can be adjusted since it affects total receivable from the client.

Alternate Terms

- Sale Return is also called: Sales Return, Return Inward, Customer Return, Goods Return
- Credit Note is also called: CN, Credit Memo, Store Credit, Credit Voucher
- Refund is also called: Reimbursement, Cashback, Money Back
- Adjust / Adjustment is also called: Apply, Offset, Set Off, Redeem
- Carry Forward is also called: Roll Over, Defer, Pending Credit

Video Tutorials

- Record Sale Return & Refund: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GamzorLvw1s>
(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GamzorLvw1s>).

- Adjust Sale Return with Credit Note: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GamzorLvw1s>
(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GamzorLvw1s>)
- Issue a Credit Note to Client: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tlphGNPEiVs> (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tlphGNPEiVs>)
- Adjust Credit Note Against Multiple Invoices: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mLJWo9v02Ro>
(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mLJWo9v02Ro>)

FAQs

Q: What is a sale return in SIM? A: A sale return is created when a customer returns goods from a previous invoice. It connects to the original invoice, records what was returned, keeps the sale record intact, and adds returned items back to inventory.

Q: Why should I not delete the original invoice when a customer returns goods? A: Deleting an invoice misrepresents financial history. The original sale happened and must stay in the books. A sale return offsets the original invoice without erasing it — this is standard accounting practice.

Q: What is a credit note? A: A credit note records the monetary value owed back to the customer after a return. The amount can either be refunded in cash or bank, or used to reduce a future invoice.

Q: How to issue a credit note to a client? A: First, ensure that the Credit Note feature is enabled from Settings. Then Go to Side Menu → Credit Note → Create Note List → select client → enter amount → Save. When the client makes a future purchase, create an invoice and the available credit will appear for adjustment.

Q: How to adjust a credit note against multiple invoices? A: Open the credit note → tap Adjust Credit Note Against Invoice. Only unpaid or partially paid invoices appear. Enter the adjustment amount for each invoice → review summary → tap Next to confirm.

Q: What happens to inventory when a sale return is created? A: Returned items are automatically added back to inventory when the sale return is saved.

Q: What is the difference between a refund and an adjustment on a credit note? A: A refund means money is physically returned to the client in cash or via bank. An adjustment means the credit reduces the client's next invoice total without any money changing hands.

[Topic: Sub Users Approvals]

11. Sub Users & Approvals

Definition

Sub users are separate login accounts created by the business owner for team members (staff, accountants, sales team). Each sub user has a role that defines what they can see and do in the app. The Transaction Approval feature ensures all transactions made by sub users require owner sign-off before becoming live.

When & Who

- When the business grows beyond a single user.
- When staff create invoices but only the owner finalizes them.
- When different employees handle specific tasks (invoicing, payments) and oversight is needed.
- When managing multiple sales reps and restricting access to sensitive data.

Navigation

Side Menu (☰) → Sub User Management → Manage Sub Users

Sub User Limits

- Maximum 5 sub users can be added to an account.
- Only 3 sub users can be active at the same time.
- Sub users can be disabled, re-enabled, edited, or deleted at any time.
- This feature is available only for paid (subscribed) users.

Predefined Roles

Available built-in roles:

- Partner / Manager
- Sales and Billing
- Purchase Manager
- Payment Collector
- Accountant

Custom Role

The owner can define a custom role with exactly the permissions required:

- Navigate to Add Sub-User → Role dropdown → + Add Custom Role
- Enter role name, check or uncheck documents and permissions → Save Role

Key Fields & Settings

- **Sub User Name** — Display name of the team member.
- **Role** — The assigned position that determines the sub user's permission set.
- **Permissions** — Individual access controls specifying what the sub user can view, create, edit, or delete.
- **Transaction Requires Approval** — When enabled, all sub user transactions enter a pending queue and are not live until the owner approves them.
- **Approval Status** — Pending = awaiting owner review. Approved = live in system. Rejected = not accepted.

Approval Workflow

Sub User Steps:

1. Sub user creates an invoice or estimate → it enters Approval Pending status.
2. Sub user can check Approval Pending Transactions for pending documents.
3. Sub user can check Approval Rejected Transactions for rejected documents.
4. Sub user can edit a rejected document → tap Update → document returns to Approval Pending.

Owner / Main User Steps:

1. Side Menu (☰) → Cloud Account → Approval Pending Transactions.
2. If the invoice includes a new client or product, approve those first.
3. Approve the invoice → it moves to the main transaction list and becomes live.

Logical Behaviors

- Maximum 3 active sub users allowed at one time.
- Sub users have limited access to app settings.
- If a client is rejected by the owner, all related documents (invoice, delivery note, etc.) are permanently deleted from the approval list. The sub user must recreate the document.
- Sub user can edit documents in Approval Pending status but cannot modify them after approval.
- Sub users cannot access features not enabled by the main user (e.g., Inventory, Commission, Delivery Note, Cash/Bank Transfer, Other Income).
- If restricted, sub users cannot edit rates in invoices, estimates, sale orders, or purchases.
- The main user can reset or change a sub user's password to revoke access.
- Payment approval depends on the approval of the related invoice.
- Proper device syncing is required to reflect updates across users.

Key Concept: Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

Each user is assigned a role, and each role carries a defined set of permissions. This ensures team members only access what is relevant to their function. A salesperson can create invoices but cannot view profit reports or delete records.

Key Concept: Why Approve New Clients/Products First

When a sub user creates a new client or product during a transaction, those records exist only in a pending state. The owner must validate them before they become permanent records. This prevents duplicate entries, typographical errors, or unauthorized additions.

Alternate Terms

- Sub User is also called: Staff Account, Employee Login, Team Member, Secondary User
- Role is also called: User Role, Access Level, Permission Level, Profile
- Transaction Requires Approval is also called: Maker-Checker, Dual Control, Approval Workflow, Authorization Workflow

- Approval Pending is also called: Awaiting Review, Under Approval, Pending Authorization

Video Tutorials

- How to Create Sub Users: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rfirjho4Njs> (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rfirjho4Njs>)
- Transaction Requires Approval: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SAFW1J735_s (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SAFW1J735_s)

FAQs

Q: What is a sub user in SIM? A: A sub user is a separate login account created for a team member with specific roles and permissions. The owner controls what each sub user can see and do in the app.

Q: How to create a sub user in SIM? A: Go to Side Menu (☰) → Sub User Management → Manage Sub Users → tap + → enter details → select role → tap Submit.

Q: How many sub users can I add? A: Up to 5 sub users can be added. Only 3 can be active at the same time.

Q: What happens when Transaction Requires Approval is enabled? A: All transactions created by sub users go into an Approval Pending queue. They are not live until the owner reviews and approves them. Sub users cannot edit or delete transactions after approval.

Q: Why does the owner need to approve new clients before approving an invoice? A: If a sub user creates a new client during a transaction, that client exists only in pending state. The owner must approve the client record first to make it a permanent entry, then approve the related invoice.

Q: What happens if the owner rejects a client record? A: If a client is rejected, all related documents (invoices, delivery notes, etc.) created by the sub user are permanently deleted from the approval list. The sub user must recreate them.

Q: Can sub users access all app features? A: No. Sub users can only access features enabled by the main user. Features like Inventory, Commission, Delivery Note, Cash/Bank Transfer, and Other Income are not accessible to sub users unless the main user has enabled them and granted permission.

Q: Is the Sub User feature available in the free trial? A: No. Sub user management is available only for paid (subscribed) users.

Q: How to create Delivery Note? A: First, ensure that the Delivery Note feature is enabled from Settings. Then Go to Side Menu → Delivery Note → Create Note → select client → enter amount → Save.

[Topic: GST Compliance India]

12. GST Compliance — India

Definition

SIM integrates directly with India's government GST infrastructure, enabling businesses to generate GST-compliant documents — E-Invoices and E-Way Bills — without logging into government portals separately.

All GST compliance features apply only to GST-registered businesses in India.

Who It Applies To

- **E-Invoice (IRN):** Mandatory for GST-registered businesses with annual turnover exceeding ₹5 crore, for all B2B transactions.
- **E-Way Bill:** Required when transporting goods valued above ₹50,000 within India. Inter-state rules apply universally; intra-state rules vary by state.

Core GST Concepts

- **GSTIN (GST Identification Number)** — A 15-digit unique identifier assigned to every GST-registered business in India. Encodes state code, PAN number, and entity type. Mandatory on all tax invoices.
 - **GSP (GST Suvidha Provider)** — A government-authorized intermediary that provides a secure API channel between third-party apps like SIM and the GST portal. The GSP used by SIM is: BVMIT Consulting Services India Private Limited.
 - **GSP Credentials (Username & Password)** — Separate from the regular GST portal login. Created specifically for API-based integration. Entered once in SIM to authorize the app to communicate with the government system.
 - **IRP (Invoice Registration Portal)** — The government portal where B2B invoices are submitted and registered to receive an IRN.
 - **IRN (Invoice Reference Number)** — A unique 64-character hash generated by the IRP for each registered B2B invoice. Printed on the invoice along with a QR barcode and acknowledgement number.
 - **E-Invoice** — A B2B invoice registered with the IRP and assigned an IRN. The invoice is created in SIM; the IRN is fetched from the government portal via the GSP connection.
 - **E-Way Bill (EWB)** — A digitally generated document required before transporting goods worth more than ₹50,000. Contains goods details, origin, destination, and transporter information.
 - **Input Tax Credit (ITC)** — Allows GST-registered businesses to reduce their GST liability by the GST already paid on purchases. Requires a valid tax invoice with IRN where applicable.
 - **UQC (Unique Quantity Code)** — A standardized, mandatory format for measurement units in e-invoice creation. The IRP requires all units to be reported using a fixed UQC list (e.g., NOS for pieces, KGS for kilograms). Free-text units are not accepted.
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A. GSP Setup for E-Invoice

Definition

A one-time setup that creates GSP credentials on the government e-invoice portal and links them to SIM. Without this, SIM cannot communicate with the government system to generate IRNs.

Key Fields

- **GSTIN** — Your 15-digit GST Identification Number. Used to validate your business on the portal.
- **GSP** — Authorized provider used by SIM: BVMIT Consulting Services India Private Limited.
- **GSP Username** — Created on the e-invoice portal. Always prefixed with API_ (e.g., API_yourusername).
- **GSP Password** — Linked to the GSP username. Must be updated in the app if changed on the portal.
- **Validate Seller GSTIN** — Verifies GSTIN against government records and auto-fills legal business name and address.

Important: GSP credentials are completely separate from your regular GST portal login. They are used only for app-to-portal integration.

Video Tutorial

GSP Username & Password for E-Invoice: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dPSmtTALqQE>
(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dPSmtTALqQE>)

B. Generating an E-Invoice (IRN)

Definition

An e-invoice is a B2B invoice officially registered with the IRP and assigned a unique IRN. Legally required for businesses with annual turnover above ₹5 crore. Once generated, the invoice is locked — it cannot be edited or deleted.

Key Fields

- **Invoice Type** — Must be set to B2B for e-invoicing. B2B = transaction between two GST-registered businesses.
- **HSN Code** — Mandatory for e-invoice. Classifies the type of goods or services for GST purposes.
- **UQC (Unique Quantity Code)** — Mandatory standardized unit format required by the IRP (e.g., NOS, KGS, LTR).
- **IRN** — The unique 64-character hash generated by the IRP. Printed on the invoice.
- **Acknowledgement Number** — A sequential confirmation number issued alongside the IRN.
- **QR Barcode** — Machine-readable code printed on the e-invoice encoding key invoice data for verification.

E-Invoice Rules

- Once an IRN is generated, the invoice cannot be edited or deleted.
- Cancellation is only possible within 24 hours of IRN generation.
- After 24 hours, the IRN is permanent and cannot be reversed.

E-Invoice Statuses

- **Ready for E-Invoice** — Invoice saved and eligible; IRN not yet generated.
- **IRN Generated** — E-invoice successfully registered with the government.
- **Cancelled** — IRN cancelled within the 24-hour window.

Video Tutorial

How to Generate E-Invoice (IRN): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nobz4DVwbzc> (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nobz4DVwbzc>)

C. GSP Setup for E-Way Bill

Definition

Generating e-way bills from SIM requires GSP credentials created on the government e-way bill portal. The process is identical to e-invoice GSP setup but done on a separate portal.

If already an e-invoice portal user, the same portal login credentials can be used to log in to the e-way bill portal.

However, GSP credentials (API username/password) must be created separately on each portal.

Portal Details

- E-Invoice portal: einvoice1.gst.gov.in
- E-Way Bill portal: ewaybill.gst.gov.in

Video Tutorial

GSP Username & Password for E-Way Bill: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dPSmtTALqQE>
(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dPSmtTALqQE>)

D. Generating an E-Way Bill

Definition

An e-way bill is a mandatory digital document required before transporting goods worth more than ₹50,000 within India.

Must be generated before goods leave the business premises. Without it, goods can be held at checkpoints and penalties may apply.

Key Fields

- **Seller GSTIN** — Your GST number. Validated against government records.
- **Buyer GSTIN** — The client's GST number. Both seller and buyer must be GST-validated before an e-way bill can be generated.
- **Legal Name** — Official registered business name of the seller or buyer. Auto-fetched after GSTIN validation.
- **HSN Code** — Mandatory. Classifies the goods being transported.

- **Measurement Unit (UQC)** — Mandatory standardized unit (e.g., KGS, NOS, LTR).
- **Transporter Details** — Vehicle or courier information. Required to complete the e-way bill.
- **E-Way Bill Number** — The unique number generated upon successful submission. Must accompany goods during transport.

E-Way Bill Generation — Two Ways

- From the E-Way Bill Section: Side Menu → Invoices → E-Way Bill → select invoice → fill details → Generate E-Way Bill.
- From the Invoice Form directly: fill invoice details → tap Generate E-Way Bill → e-way bill form opens and invoice is auto-saved.

GSTIN Validation — Two Ways

- From Client section: Clients → select client → tap Validate GSTIN → enter details → validate.
- From Invoice form: select client → tap edit icon → enter GSTIN details → validate.

E-Way Bill Rules

- Required for goods worth more than ₹50,000 being transported.
- Must be generated before goods leave your premises.
- Validity: 1 day per 200 km (or part thereof) for normal cargo vehicles. 1 day per 20 km for over-dimensional cargo.
- If validation fails, the system shows a specific error. Fix the flagged fields and retry. No penalty for failed attempts.

Video Tutorial

How to Generate E-Way Bill: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nobz4DVwbzc> (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nobz4DVwbzc>)

Portal Login vs. GSP Credentials — Key Distinction

- Portal login (GSTIN + password) is for manually accessing the government website.
- GSP credentials (API username + password) are exclusively for app-to-portal integration.
- These are two completely different sets of credentials.

Alternate Terms

- E-Invoice is also called: Electronic Invoice, IRN Invoice, Tax Invoice with IRN
- E-Way Bill is also called: EWB, Electronic Way Bill, Goods Movement Document
- GSTIN is also called: GST Number, GST ID, Tax ID, GST Registration Number
- GSP is also called: GST Suvidha Provider, API Provider, GST Intermediary
- IRP is also called: Invoice Registration Portal, Government E-Invoice Portal
- IRN is also called: Invoice Reference Number, E-Invoice Number
- HSN Code is also called: Harmonised System Nomenclature, Tariff Code, Product Classification Code
- UQC is also called: Unique Quantity Code, Measurement Unit Code
- ITC is also called: Input Tax Credit, GST Credit, Tax Set-Off

- Acknowledgement Number is also called: ACK Number, Confirmation Number

FAQs

Q: What is GST compliance in SIM? A: SIM integrates with India's government GST system to let businesses generate E-Invoices (IRN) and E-Way Bills directly from the app without logging into government portals separately.

Q: Who needs to use e-invoicing in India? A: GST-registered businesses with annual turnover exceeding ₹5 crore must generate e-invoices for all B2B transactions.

Q: What is GSP and why is it needed? A: GSP (GST Suvidha Provider) is a government-authorized intermediary that creates a secure connection between SIM and the GST portal. The GSP used by SIM is BVMIT Consulting Services India Private Limited.

Q: What is the difference between GSP credentials and GST portal login? A: GST portal login (GSTIN + password) is for manually accessing the government website. GSP credentials (API username + password) are created separately and are used only for app-to-portal integration. They are completely different.

Q: What is an IRN? A: IRN (Invoice Reference Number) is a unique 64-character code generated by the government's IRP for each registered B2B invoice. It confirms the invoice has been officially registered with the GST system.

Q: Can an e-invoice be edited after the IRN is generated? A: No. Once an IRN is generated, the invoice cannot be edited or deleted. It can only be cancelled within 24 hours of generation.

Q: How to cancel an e-invoice? A: Go to B2B Invoice List → Action column → three dots → Cancel IRN → choose reason → add remarks → tap OK. This must be done within 24 hours of IRN generation.

Q: What is an E-Way Bill? A: An E-Way Bill is a mandatory digital document required when transporting goods worth more than ₹50,000 within India. It must be generated before goods leave the premises.

Q: What is the validity of an e-way bill? A: 1 day per 200 km (or part thereof) for normal cargo vehicles. 1 day per 20 km for over-dimensional cargo.

Q: What is UQC? A: UQC (Unique Quantity Code) is the mandatory standardized format for measurement units required by the government's IRP for e-invoice and e-way bill generation. Examples: NOS for pieces, KGS for kilograms, LTR for litres. Free-text units are not accepted.

Q: How to set up GSP for e-invoicing? A: Log in to the e-invoice portal (einvoice1.gst.gov.in) → Left Menu → API Registration → User Credentials → verify OTP → select Through GSP → choose BVMIT Consulting Services India Private Limited → create GSP username and password → enter these credentials in SIM under Settings → E-Invoice Settings.

[Topic: Settings Cloud Account]

13. Cloud Account

Definition

The Cloud Account is the online account linked to SIM that stores and synchronizes business data across devices. It provides cross-device access (mobile, tablet, web), data security, and sync status visibility.

When & Who

Used during initial app setup, when switching to a new device, and by any user who accesses SIM from multiple devices.

Available Actions

A. Sync Data with Cloud Pushes all device data to the cloud server and pulls updated data from the server. Navigation: Side Menu → Cloud Account → Sync Data with Cloud

B. Detailed Sync View Shows sync status: number of records synced, any errors, last sync time, records pending to send, and records pending to receive. Navigation: Side Menu → Cloud Account → Detailed Sync View

C. Change Password Updates the account password from within the app. Navigation: Side Menu → Cloud Account → Change Password → enter old password, new password, and confirm password → Done

D. Forgot Password Sends a password reset link to the registered email address. Navigation: Side Menu → Cloud Account → Forgot Password → enter email address → reset link sent → set new password → log in

Alternate Terms

Cloud Backup, Data Sync, Online Account, Sync Manager, Cloud Storage Settings, Account & Sync

FAQs

Q: What is Cloud Account in SIM? A: Cloud Account is the online account that stores and synchronizes all business data across devices. It enables access from multiple phones, tablets, and the web version.

Q: How to sync data with the cloud in SIM? A: Go to Side Menu → Cloud Account → Sync Data with Cloud. This pushes device data to the server and pulls any updates.

Q: How to change the account password in SIM? A: Go to Side Menu → Cloud Account → Change Password → enter old password, new password, and confirm → Done.

Q: How to reset a forgotten password in SIM? A: Go to Side Menu → Cloud Account → Forgot Password → enter your email address → click the reset link sent to your email → set a new password.

Q: What does the Detailed Sync View show? A: It shows the number of records synced, any errors, the last sync time, and records pending to send or receive.
